

THIS WEEK in ART

By Emily Genauer

The  Sun

SATURDAY, MARCH 17, 1945.

MELVILLE UPTON.

Sievan Exhibit.

In complete contrast is Maurice Sievan, having a large one-man exhibit at the Mortimer Brandt Gallery. Sievan is plainly a man of gentle spirit and modest aim. He is the poet laureate, as it were, of suburbia. He paints the ugly front-stooped frame houses of Jamaica, main street on a gray day, the bus stop, the large motor highway running quickly past Flushing.

He doesn't sentimentalize. Nor does he satirically make a fetish of ugliness. He finds in his subject a peculiar poetry—the warm, plain background of simple people. He doesn't paint the people, but you feel their presence. Perhaps all this sounds folksy. Perish forbid. Then Pissarro is folksy, or Sisley, or the other French impressionists. Because Sievan, using more breadth and freedom in his brush strokes, quieter color, firmer design, does put one in mind of that particular group of painters. He sees nature much as they did—but interprets it in terms singularly personal.

The Borough of Queens has found a whole-hearted celebrant in Maurice Sievan, the current exhibitor at the Mortimer Brandt Gallery, 15 East 57th street. Although the artist was born in Russia he has been in this country since he was nine years old. He now lives in Flushing and paints it and its environs and always on the spot. He has even found something paintable in Forest Hills, although that fancifully named locality has neither a forest nor hills. Painting "on the spot" is rarely the ideal way to paint landscape. It is apt to pin the artist down to the factual and banish such dreams as might come when alone with memory in the studio. But then every one to his taste. And apparently Mr. Sievan gets away with it to his satisfaction. He seems at his best in "East River Driveway," with its fine arch stretched across the empty sky; "Under Suburban Skys," and "Jamaica Landscape."

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AT THE ART GALLERIES

By A. Z. KRUSE

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By HOWARD DEVREE

Loose, free, sensitive impressionism characterizes the painting by Maurice Sievan at the Brandt Gallery. Frequently using an almost wet wash water-color technique in these suburban Long Island landscapes, Sievan strives for sketchy atmospheric effects, seldom pushing his realization of forms far. Essentially lyric work, this.

Mortimer Brandt Gallery

Maurice Sievan evidently has great affection for his Flushing, L. I., environment. If he can get his neighbors and fellow residents to feel what he sees into his canvases, they shall have added to their souls an alertness to ever-present beauty around them, and even a short walk may become an adventure of spiritual delight. A street corner reserved for a "Bus Stop" in the residential section is inspiringly sketched and filled with emotional rhythm. Other canvases which Sievan paints with a passion for the beauty which surrounds him, in a manner equivalent to an exalted style of prose, are "At Eventide," "Tonal Landscape," and "Homes." Any one who paints as well as his "Self-Portrait" indicates should show more portraits.